

Eco-Rating Core Criteria Questions

The following questions form the mandatory baseline within the Eco-Rating self-assessment.

CORPORATE QUESTIONS

Q1) Does your hotel have a written sustainability policy (or set of policies) in place?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO

Instructions: Member MUST select “YES” and upload their sustainability policy. A template will be provided.

Q1a) Has the sustainability policy been endorsed (approved and signed) by a hotel senior corporate officer?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO

Instructions: Member MUST select “YES”.

Q1b)

Is a senior manager/officer accountable for monitoring the policy implementation, to ensure the hotel operations are aligning with the sustainability policy?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO

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Instructions: Member MUST select “YES”.

Q1c) Is the sustainability policy communicated to all members of the organization?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO

Instructions: Member MUST select “YES”.

Q1d) The hotel-wide sustainability policy includes commitment to addressing the following (select all that apply):

- **Environmental issues — MANDATORY**
- **Social and cultural issues — MANDATORY**
- Economic and quality issues
- Health and safety issues
- Human rights
- Risk and crisis management
- At least one environmental target set by the company
- **Ongoing, continuous improvement — MANDATORY**
- **Energy conservation and efficient use — MANDATORY**
- Greenhouse gas emissions reduction
- **Water conservation — MANDATORY**
- **Waste reduction — MANDATORY**
- Reduction in and proper handling of hazardous and toxic substances
- Eco-purchasing (environmentally preferred purchasing)
- Procurement of local goods and services
- Reduce disposable and consumable goods
- Biodiversity conservation
- Employee education and engagement
- Community involvement and support
- Improving accessibility

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- Guest education and awareness
- None of the above

Instructions: Member is to select all that apply but MUST select all options listed as “MANDATORY”.

Q1f) Does the policy or set of policies cover a long-term approach and has the policy been developed suitable to the hotel’s size and scope of services?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO

Instructions: Member MUST select “YES”.

Q2) Does a written management action plan exist that addresses policy commitments?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO

Instructions: Member MUST select “YES” and upload their Action Plan. A template will be provided.

Q2a) When was the written management action plan last reviewed or revised?

Answer Options:

- The implemented plan has been reviewed within the past 12 months
- Not reviewed in over one year

Instructions: Member MUST select “The implemented plan has been reviewed within the past 12 months”.

Q2b) The hotel’s written management action plan includes the following (select all that apply):

- Performance indicators
- Quantified performance targets
- **Ongoing measurement and monitoring — MANDATORY**
- Third-party verification
- Improvement reflected in employee performance/reward
- None of the above

Instructions: Member is to select all that apply but MUST select all option listed as “MANDATORY”

Q3) Does the hotel have a written responsible purchasing policy that prioritizes the following elements? (select all that apply)

- **Local sourcing — MANDATORY**
- **Recycled content (paper, plastics, etc.) — MANDATORY**
- **Eco-friendly products — MANDATORY**
- Upcycled products
- Natural fibers
- **Certified responsible/green products — MANDATORY**
- **Local eco-friendly or certified responsible suppliers — MANDATORY**
- Reusable (no single use)
- None of the above

Instructions: Member is to select all that apply but MUST select all option listed as “MANDATORY”. Member is also required to upload their purchasing policy. A template will be provided.

Q9) Has a Green Team been assigned responsibility for directing and coordinating environmental initiatives?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO

Instructions: Member MUST select “YES”.

Q9a) The Green Team is comprised of:

- Representatives from all departments and management
- One environmental coordinator / champion
- Representatives from multiple departments
- Representatives from multiple departments and management

Instructions: Member is to select the appropriate option.

Q9b) Does the hotel's Green Team have a written mandate with support from senior management?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO

Instructions: Member MUST select “YES” and upload their written mandate. A template will be provided.

Q9c) Does the hotel's Green Team meet at least quarterly?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO

Instructions: Member MUST select "YES".

Q13) Which paper conservation initiatives in offices/administration areas are in place? (select all that apply)

- Scratch pads made from used paper
- **Guest folios emailed instead of printed — MANDATORY**
- Default double-sided printing
- Remove unsolicited magazines/catalogues
- Electronic bulletin board for staff announcements
- Packaging and shipping paper reused

Instructions: Member is to select all that apply but MUST select all option listed as "MANDATORY".

HOUSEKEEPING QUESTIONS

Q1) Is there a formal program in place which allows guests to opt out of housekeeping (reuse linens and/or towels)?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO

Instructions: Member MUST select "YES".

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Q2) Are standard set-points used for all guest room thermostats and communicated to housekeeping staff?

Options:

- **Set point relevant to regional climate — MANDATORY**
- Lower set point when unoccupied
- None of the above

Instructions: Member MUST select the option listed as “MANDATORY”.

Q4) Are housekeeping staff trained to use natural light when cleaning guestrooms?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO

Instructions: Member MUST select “YES”.

Q5) Are housekeeping staff trained to open or close blinds and drapes according to heating/cooling needs?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO

Instructions: Member MUST select “YES”.

Q6) Are housekeepers trained to ensure windows and external doors are closed when heating or cooling systems are in use?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO
- N/A

Instructions: Member MUST select “YES”.

Q7) Are housekeepers trained to check that lights, radios, and televisions are turned off in unoccupied rooms?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO

Instructions: Member MUST select “YES”.

Q18) What percentage of cleaning products are eco-friendly?

- Less than 25%
- 25–49%
- 50–74%
- 75–99%
- 100%

Instructions: Member is to select the appropriate option.

Q19) Do you have a policy and procedure in place concerning proper handling and disposal of cleaning supplies and medical waste?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO

Instructions: Member MUST select “YES” and upload their policy. A template will be provided.

Q20) Are housekeeping staff trained to minimize water use when cleaning?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO

Instructions: Member MUST select “YES”.

Q21) Are housekeepers trained to report faulty equipment to Maintenance?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO

Instructions: Member MUST select “YES”.

ENGINEERING QUESTIONS

Q4) Are annual use and costs of electricity being measured and tracked?

Answer Options:

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- YES
- NO

Instructions: Member MUST select “YES” and upload their documents. An example will be provided.

Q5) Are annual use and costs of natural gas being measured and tracked?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO
- N/A (if not used)

Instructions: Member MUST select “YES” and upload their documents. An example will be provided.

Q11) Are annual use and costs of water being measured and tracked?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO

Instructions: Member MUST select “YES” and upload their documents. An example will be provided.

Q15) Is there a regularly scheduled preventative maintenance program that includes:

- **Heating and cooling systems — MANDATORY**
- **Ventilation systems — MANDATORY**

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- **Plumbing — MANDATORY**
- **Lighting upgrades — MANDATORY**
- No preventative maintenance program

Instructions: Member is to select all that apply but MUST select all options listed as “MANDATORY”. Member is also required to upload their maintenance program. A template will be provided.

Q17) Rather than running HVAC (Heating, Ventilation, and Air Conditioning) systems continuously, which of the following practices/modifications have been made to improve energy efficiency? (select all that apply)

- **Scheduled checks by trained personnel — MANDATORY**
- Control systems (timers/sensors)
- Variable speed drives
- Computer control system
- None of the above

Instructions: Member is to select all that apply but MUST select all options listed as “MANDATORY”.

Q22) Which of the following insulation measures have been taken? (select all that apply)

- **Doors/windows weather stripped or caulked — MANDATORY**
- **Entry doors revolving or kept closed — MANDATORY**
- Air ducts sealed and insulated
- Gasket insulators
- Loading dock protections
- None of the above

Instructions: Member is to select all that apply but MUST select all options listed as “MANDATORY”.

Q23) Which of the following features have been installed on windows to reduce solar energy gains? (select all that apply)

- **Blinds/curtains/shutters — MANDATORY**
- Awnings
- External shades
- Automatic blinds
- Fritting
- Spectrally selective coatings
- None of the above

Instructions: Member is to select all that apply but MUST select all options listed as “MANDATORY”.

Q38) Which of the following are used for outdoor lighting (building exterior, signage, parking garage, and/or security lighting)? (select all that apply)

- **Energy-efficient light bulbs — MANDATORY**
- Photocell sensors
- Timers
- Motion detectors
- None of the above

Instructions: Member is to select all that apply but MUST select all options listed as “MANDATORY”.

Q39) Is energy efficiency considered when purchasing new appliances/equipment?

Answer Options:

- YES
- NO

Instructions: Member MUST select “YES”.

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Q40) What percentage of guestrooms have been equipped with low-flow showerheads? (1.5 GPM - 2 GPM / 5.68 LPM - 7.57 LPM)

- <25%
- 25–49%
- 50–74%
- 75–99%
- 100%

Instructions: Member is to select the appropriate option.

Q41) What percentage of guestrooms have been equipped with tap aerators? (0.5 GPM, 1.9 LPM)

- <25%
- 25–49%
- 50–74%
- 75–99%
- 100%

Instructions: Member is to select the appropriate option.

Q42) What percentage of guestrooms have been equipped with low-flow toilets (1.1-1.6 gallons/4-6 liters per flush), dual-flush toilets (0.8-1.6 gallons/3-6 liters per flush), toilet dams, or tank fill diverters?

- <25%
- 25–49%
- 50–74%
- 75–99%
- 100%



Instructions: Member is to select the appropriate option.

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